

Rachel E. N. Hester
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August 2026

EDUCATION

MS Biology, California State Polytechnic University, Pomona (CPP) 2025 – present

- Topic: Effects of Temperature on Bite Force Variables in Two Species of Alligator Lizard (*Elgaria coerulea* and *Elgaria multicarinata*)
- Advisor: Dr. A. Kristopher Lappin, PhD
- GPA: 4.00

BS Biology, CPP 2025

- Minor in Studio Arts
- Total GPA: 3.97, Major GPA: 4.00
- President's Honors List: 2021-2025

EXPERIENCE

Vivarium Graduate Student Assistant, CPP Aug 2026 – present

- Husbandry of animal collection
- Gave educational talks to elementary, middle school, and college students

Master's Research, CPP Aug 2025 – present

PI: Dr. A. Kristopher Lappin, PhD, Biological Sciences Department

- Topic: Effects of Temperature on Bite Force in Two Species of Alligator Lizard (*Elgaria coerulea* and *Elgaria multicarinata*)
- Field work capturing wild lizards
- Husbandry of research subjects
- Tested lizard bite force using force transducer and data acquisition system (LabChart Lightning)
- Inventoried, organized, and maintained equipment

Teaching Associate, CPP Aug 2025 – present

BIO 2350L Human Physiology Fall 2026

BIO 1220L Foundations of Biology: Evolution, Ecology, and Biodiversity Lab Spring 2026

BIO 1150L Basic Biology Lab Fall 2025

- Gave mini-lectures on weekly lab topics
- Lab set-up and facilitation
- Maintained and cleaned lab
- Graded weekly lab reports
- Wrote and proctored quizzes

Biology Grader, CPP Jan 2025 – May 2025

BIO 3250 Principles of Ecology

- Graded assignments

Undergraduate Research, CPP

Aug 2023 – May 2025

PI: Dr. Rachel Blakey, PhD, Biological Sciences Department

Led Bat Night outreach events and assisted with projects collecting and identifying bat calls, and monitored movement of bobcats and great gray owls in ArcGIS Pro.

- Led public outreach Bat Nights, helped with event planning, created educational material, set up, and collected donations
- Used ultrasonic detectors to record bat calls and assisted with setup of mist nets
- Vetted data and identified species for bat feeding buzz study in Sonobat
- Vetted data for bobcat minimum crossings and great gray owl road crossings studies in ArcGIS Pro

AWARDS

Steven J. Wickler Memorial Scholarship 2026-2027

Susan Dove Memorial Scholarship 2026-2027

ACADEMIC SERVICE & VOLUNTEER WORK

Volunteer at OC Parks and OC Zoo (2026 – Present)

Volunteer at Cal Poly Vivarium and BioTrek, Cal Poly Pomona (2024 – 26)

Treasurer, Bat Advocacy and Tracking Society (student club), Cal Poly Pomona (2024 – 26)

Secretary and Co-Historian, Nikkei Student Union (student club), Cal Poly Pomona (2023 – 24)

Zoologists of Cal Poly Pomona (student club), Cal Poly Pomona (2021-2024, (Fundraising Chair 2021 – 22, President 2023 – 24)

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Red Cross First Aid, CPR, & Oxygen

Administration Certification

CITI Program Training, Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC):

- For the Protocol Personnel (Faculty, Staff, Students)
- When Working with Reptiles, Amphibians and Fish
- Wildlife Research

Microsoft Suite

Intermediate ArcGIS Pro

Beginner Google Earth Engine

Intermediate R Coding

Git

ADInstruments LabChart Lightning

Sonobat

Zotero Reference Management Software

Ecoassist

Adobe Creative Cloud

Museum Specimen Preparation

REFERENCES

Dr. A. Kristopher Lappin, PhD aklappin@cpp.edu
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Dr. Rachel Blakey, PhD rvblakey@cpp.edu
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Tatiana Vargas, MS tavargas@cpp.edu
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